

Fellowship With the Father Changes Receiving

Gifts Can Flow Through a Person Who Still Struggles to Receive

Thank You, Jesus.

Since the days of learning to put up the shield of faith, hostile crowds and fiery darts of the enemy have not affected my preaching much. People who did not seem to be in agreement did not affect it much. People obviously having a bad time did not affect it much. Not even getting threatened affected it much. I learned how to slip behind the shield of faith, which quenches all the fiery darts.

People teach about atmospheres God needs in order to work. I know this part is true: you cannot create one and carry it around with you if it does not change the level you are receiving on.

Over the long term, I have watched people and preachers who had trouble with their faith. I am not talking about trouble with gifts or public ministry. I am talking about trouble with their own faith.

The hardest I have ever been kicked was like being kicked by a mule, and it happened when a woman sitting in a wheelchair prayed for me. It took me hours to recover. I know a lot of people who know how to yield to a gift. They can believe God will do it for somebody else. Mostly, the gifts are given by grace. A person has a calling and is far enough along to know what God wants to do for other people.

For many of them, it is a great mystery why He does it. Finally they dismiss it as sovereignty: God moved like that and healed them because He wanted to. But a lot of times they themselves cannot receive it. Many ministries have been stopped by the very diseases that were healed in their ministries.

So doctrines are born out of those reasonings, like, "It is not His will to heal everyone." If the only man on the planet was Adam, and it was not God's will to heal him, then Jesus would not have had to bear your sicknesses and carry your pains. He could have left that part out.

Where I find most of the breakdown is this: people know Him well enough to know He may sovereignly do something for someone else, but they do not know Him well enough to know what He would do for them.

In the transition from God to God the Father, someone's faith is reaching. We have to talk about this for a moment.

Jesus Used Parables to Reveal the Father to Spiritually Dead Hearers

Jesus, in His deity, knew the molecular structure of the cross He was crucified on. At times He alluded to His deity when He was challenged about who He was. The Pharisees said, "Thou art not yet fifty years old, and hast thou seen Abraham?"

Jesus said, "Before Abraham was, I am."

He could allude to His deity. Yet when He taught the transition from God, who He was to the Old Testament saints, to Father, He said, "The law and the prophets were until John: since that time the kingdom of God is preached, and every man presseth into it."

He was fulfilling the old covenant and preaching the principles of the new. He said to those outside, these things are hidden in a mystery, but to those He was teaching, it was given to know the mysteries of the kingdom.

When He taught the parable of the sower and finally got to the good ground, thirty, sixty, and a hundredfold, He said a candle is not lit to be hidden under a bushel or a bed, but put on a candlestick. Nothing is hidden except to be made manifest.

He was saying, "You may not understand these things I am teaching because you are spiritually dead. But the day is coming when your candle will be lit. You will be born again. Everything hidden in darkness will be understood by you, and everything will be uncovered. You will begin to understand who I am teaching about, which is the Father."

I particularly love the way Jesus taught. Anyone who had to do with creating the principles that moved Einstein into his theories, anyone who could understand physics enough to predict what the atom bomb would do, has quite a mind. Yet when Jesus taught, He said, "Consider the lily."

He compared the lily to someone they knew: Solomon in all his glory was not clothed like one of these. They are so temporary, decorating a field today with beauty Solomon could only dream about, and tomorrow they are baking a woman's bread in her oven.

His question was this: if God so clothed something so temporary, how is it that you have problems with faith?

He is the One who taught me how to teach. That is why I use Baby Huey the duck raised with chickens, baby piranha adopted by a goldfish, and Cain, my timber wolf, who I had to restrain with law because he had a nature that ate the neighbor's domestic animals.

Cain the Wolf Shows Why Law Restrains an Unchanged Nature

Cain could not live among humans without being restrained by law. Cain knew I loved him. If I had time, I would run him around the yard. But if he got out of my sight, he would eat the neighbor's cats. Beating him would not help, because that was his nature.

So I had to restrain him with law. I put him on a big chain. He could no more live in a society of human beings without being restrained by law than God could live among Old Testament saints without restraining their nature by law.

To get Cain to do what I wanted concerning the neighbors, I had to put him on a big chain or lock him in a cage, or he would run off and eat their cats, whip their dogs, eat their chickens, and eat their goats. He even ate part of my house. He got through the insulation and ate into the house. I came out and yelled, "Cain, aren't you supposed to blow my house down, not eat it?"

I had to restrain Cain by law, or I could not have him as a pet. It hurt me so badly that I finally gave him to someone who had a fenced ranch where he could run free.

God could not operate in the midst of spiritually dead men without restraining them with law. When people had me under law, I gave because they put me in the pen and beat me to death. But now that I have His nature, you do not have to restrain me to get me to give. Something has changed on the inside, and I give liberty.

I only wanted to get into that part. Peace is not even for an offering.

The Missing Piece Is Fellowship, Not More Information

Someone is having trouble receiving from God, and that is the person I have been addressing. The key you are looking for is that you need to get to know Him.

Most of our unbelief problem is because we cannot believe what we discern the Word to say after we read it, because we do not know very well the One who said it. But He gave you a new nature to get acquainted with Him.

Many people know enough Scripture to know He bore their sicknesses and carried their pains. They know the covenant caused them not only to be born again, but to become sons with an unfathomable inheritance. God is not the One holding back funds from winning this city or the next one. He wants them saved more than I do. I did not die for them. He did.

We do not understand inheritance very much because we do not understand sonship very much. Inheritance is based more on inheriting what your Father has, and more on fellowship with Him, than on legal rights you are trying to hold up before you as His son.

Even in adoption, when the adoption process is complete, they are not adopted anymore. They are bone of your bone and marrow of your marrow. If an adopted child is left out of inheritance that you gave to a biological child, you will irritate God.

The area many are lacking in when receiving from Him is not understanding what He did. It is not that He has not provided healing, blessing, and peace. Most of you have heard enough. You live in Tulsa. Even when you get mad and go to another church, you hear much of the same thing.

What is lacking now is not really your knowledge. For many, it is your fellowship with Him.

You have no idea what getting to know the One who said what He said about your faith will do to your faith. What is it worth to really get to know Him in private worship? It depends on how much you think your hour is worth. If you do nothing, your hours will not be worth much in the future. If you start now, two or three years from now you will pass through the same hour, and it will have changed things in both directions.

The Prodigal Story Exposes the Elder Brother's Lack of Fellowship

The prodigal son is really about the elder brother. Both sons were given inheritance. One boy took his and squandered it on riotous living. Later, when he came back, the father said, "This was your brother, my son, who was lost and now is found."

The younger son first broke relationship and fellowship and went off into another country. He had to come to himself. But let's talk about him getting home.

The difference between relationship and fellowship is this: relationship is two relatives in the same ship because they are in the same gene pool. You may not like the people in the boat, but you are a relative. Fellowship is people in the same ship because they like it.

The younger son broke fellowship and relationship. But five minutes after the father restored relationship, he restored fellowship. The father was happy. He got the robe, killed the fatted calf, and celebrated.

The elder brother was in the field. The servants went to get him. "Come. Your brother was lost and is found."

He said, "No."

So the father went out and entreated him. "Come. It is right that I killed the fatted calf. Your brother was lost and now is found."

The elder brother said, "No. I have always kept your commandments. I have always done everything you asked, and you never killed a fatted calf for me."

The father had divided full inheritance to both of them. He said, "Son, all I have ever had has been yours the whole time."

In other words, "Your problem is that you never knew Me well enough to know that. You based your walk with Me on your works instead of the grace that made you My son. You have not known Me well enough to know that all I ever had has been yours the whole time."

Some of you are in a fight. You have not been putting yourself in the direction of the Spirit that fights the good fight and obtains what you need as a son. You are not laying hold on His grace and pulling it in so God can come and do something for you that you have not earned.

Where faith really shines is when you know what He is talking about today: fellowship with Him, particularly private fellowship. Then your faith develops and shines in that area. When you are convinced enough to know that fellowship with Him is going to change the grace you walk in, faith says, "Everything is trying to keep me from fellowshiping with Him out of my new nature, but I am not going to stop."

Stay in and keep worshipping Him until you get into fellowship that invokes His grace into situations to do what you already know He said He would do.

Praying in Tongues Reveals, but Worship Brings Presence

After praying in the Holy Ghost, the revelation gift delivered me to the limb of worship. I knew worship was doing something for my fellowship with God that praying in tongues did not do because it could not. Praying in tongues was a revelation gift.

I know ministries that have based their whole walk with God on private worship alone. They know very little Word, but they get a lot of people healed. Private worship is not a revelation gift. Private worship is adoration that builds until there is a flow from the new nature toward God, a flow of love, patience, temperance, and those things, and God responds back with compassion. That generally opens His grace and power toward other people and even toward you.

But it is not a revelation gift. I have seen people tremendously used, but with very little foundation. Many of them never make it to the end of their calling and ministry because they get taken off and destroyed in the reasoning realm.

Sometimes a move born out of the presence of God first gets visited by sensational spirits, things you cannot pin on God because they do not belong in a service: barking, crowing like roosters, violent shaking, and things like that. That may happen to you once when something in your flesh does not want to turn loose, but what does it do to a sinner who walks in and sees someone vibrating across the floor? They usually run for the door.

People want to leave the order of the service out, which includes the Word, the foundation, and everything else, and just try to make God do more and more every time by forcing Him into it. God will balance it. The best He has is to empty acres of wheelchairs and leave those people with something they can bite their teeth into to fight the devil with and stand when the hour of trial comes.

Sensationalism Is Not the Order of the Spirit

One man was so polished and articulate that when I was next to speak, I wanted to excuse myself and not come back. We were at breakfast, and he leaned over to me and said, "I heard you are an intercessor."

I said, "Yes, I like to think I am." I prayed in tongues a lot; to me that was intercession.

He said, "Can I ask you a question?"

I was thinking, "Ask on, learned one."

He leaned over and said, "When you are really heavy into intercession, does the barking anointing ever come on you?"

I lifted my head and studied every line of his face, waiting for him to break out laughing. He did not. He was serious.

I said, "I can't say it ever has."

He said, "How about the crowing, the rooster anointing?"

I said, "I cannot ever remember that one coming on me either."

I did not know there was a whole move going on with those kinds of things. I had been locked up in my closet. I could not believe he believed that.

Another man came up and asked if something he had seen was of God. He said a pastor's wife chased him down, tackled him like a football player, bit him in the back of the leg near the Achilles heel, and then prophesied through her teeth with her mouth full of his leg.

He asked, "Was that of God?"

I said, "No."

When you leave the order He set up, sensational spirits often come in, and people want them to outdo what they did the last time.

Private worship is a presence gift. Praying in tongues is a revelation gift. In 1 Corinthians 14, Paul says if I pray in an unknown tongue, my spirit prays. The Holy Spirit transfers the prayer to your human spirit by creating it there, and then you pray it out.

The simple act of praying in tongues for personal edification gives the Holy Spirit permission to form the prayer that is in the mind of Christ, pray it out for you, and give the other two members of the Godhead authority to answer it. This is what makes it a revelation gift. It will even go against your wrong believing, track down that limb, cut it off, and build you up above it until you can see it.

Worship is not a revelation gift. Praying in tongues will deliver you to worship, and worship becomes a presence gift. When you have a revelation gift with a presence gift, you are going somewhere and producing fruit that remains.

Fellowship Invokes the Grace Behind What You Already Understand

Hear what the Spirit would say: fellowship with Me will cause to be invoked in your life what you are saying and what you understand. What many of you are looking for is this fellowship with Me, where you can find the kind of grace you have been looking for, especially in the area of blessing.

Many of you have a negative program running in you because you failed to earn His blessing and inheritance with all the tithing and giving you did to everything they said to give to, and your life has not changed that much.

There is grace here. A couple of years ago, when I locked myself away for that time of worship and wept for nine hours straight, He washed me. I came back with something I did not have when I went in.

When He wants to invoke grace to help you beat your circumstances back until you can get hold, sometimes His faith, the gift of it, passes through me because it is His grace. Then He trades a little of your standing for His with that gift of faith and attacks your circumstances, driving them back enough for you to start receiving from Him. Then you can start giving yourself over in faith to what will bring permanent change instead of a temporary visitation.

If He reaches out, grabs your heart, and turns something, and you notice a difference in your circumstances, some overdue things may come online: raises, a job, and other things. When this starts happening, know it is a dinner bell being rung for you to come and get acquainted with Him.

He will not want that realm of grace to fall under legalism of the flesh. He wants you to stay in it.

Who can discount it? The elder brother never transgressed, not even once. He said, "You have not killed a fatted calf for me." The father said, "Son, all I have ever had has been yours. I divided it to you the same time I did to your younger brother. You did not know Me very well."

In most legalistic teaching, they try to get you into obedience by promising you flashy things for your giving. But faith does not work well in areas of greed, lust, or self-exaltation. Do I need to dangle a new car in front of you to get you to give? Are you interested in the lost?

God responds to a person's giving, but not to the act itself as much as the heart behind the giving. That is why He wants you. He wants you.

Not only will fellowship affect the grace you walk in regarding provision, but what makes you think fellowship with Him will not make you look at a diseased child differently than you used to?

Compassion Sees Healing as Part of the Covenant

Friday night I gave testimony about a little girl I met, about five years old, with a tumor the size of a golf ball. I remember the compassion of God. All I could do was hug her. She had a shaved head. We prayed and felt His presence come.

Since then, it culminated in a trip through the hospital and seizures. She went into seizures and a coma and was shutting down. But the friends would not stop: "She will live and not die. She will live and not die." Suddenly she came out of the coma, and the tumor was gone from her brain.

There is something wrong when you know so much about your covenant, tithing, and giving, and yet have children growing up in your church, their whole lives in a wheelchair. How about finding out about that part of the covenant?

Ephesians 5 Shows Worship, the Senses, and the Will of God

Let me show you the mind of Christ, and then I am pretty much going to let you go. Part of this is what He said in tongues, so I have to show you a few verses.

Ephesians 5:17 says:

"Wherefore be ye not unwise,
but understanding what the will of the Lord is."

Then verse 18 says:

"And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess;
but be filled with the Spirit."

How do I do that?

"Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs,
singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord;
Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father
in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ."

He says giving thanks for all things, but you have to back up to verse 17. You give Him thanks for the things within His will. That is why He said to understand what the will of the Lord is.

For a long time, I preached "be not drunk with wine" as if it simply meant getting drunk in the Holy Ghost, like on the Day of Pentecost. But that is not exactly what He is talking about.

What part of an alcoholic does alcohol affect? His senses. A man uses alcohol to sedate his senses so he can cope with life and face problems. But we do not have to be drunk with wine. Our alternative is to be filled with the Spirit. How? By ministering to ourselves in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, making melody in our hearts to the Lord, and giving thanks for all things.

Eventually, as God's presence starts coming through ministering to yourself, it affects your senses. I finally had a name for it: the baptism of the senses. It became so strong that after a while I got to thinking like God. He tilted the pendulum of my senses so far over to the faith side that when the Holy Ghost bathed them, I could not figure out why I ever doubted.

From that day to this, private worship became a great part of my confession life.

"I call myself dead to the world and alive to You, that I can separate to You all the glory and praise and magnify Your holy name. I owe no man anything but to love him. I bring no reproach on this gospel through past failures. I worship You and thank You for the hundred thousand dollars heading my way."

Then you go back into worship until your senses get so baptized that you say, "My God, why couldn't I believe that before?"

Christ as Covering and Provider Frames Worship and Provision

How do you know He is talking about fellowship and relationship with Him? Because of what He is really talking about in Ephesians 5.

Verse 23 says:

"For the husband is the head of the wife,
even as Christ is the head of the church:
and he is the saviour of the body."

The word for head is better understood as covering. The husband is the covering for the wife and family, even as Christ is the head and covering of the church. He is also the Savior of the body. Savior here means He saved you out of and into. He saved you out of sin and into righteousness, out of sickness and into healing, out of poverty and into His inheritance, out of turmoil and into peace.

He is the covering of the church, and He saved you out of to provide for.

Then Paul says:

"Therefore as the church is subject unto Christ,
so let the wives be to their own husbands in every thing."

Husbands, can you love your wives like Christ loved the church? That is the part of you they are supposed to submit to: you as provider and covering.

Paul says Christ gave Himself for the church so He might sanctify and cleanse it by the washing of water by the Word, that He might present it to Himself a glorious church, without spot or wrinkle.

Then he says:

"So ought men to love their wives as their own bodies.
He that loveth his wife loveth himself.
For no man ever yet hated his own flesh;
but nourisheth and cherisheth it,
even as the Lord the church:
For we are members of his body,
of his flesh,
and of his bones."

Then:

"For this cause shall a man leave his father and mother,
and shall be joined unto his wife,
and they two shall be one flesh.
This is a great mystery:
but I speak concerning Christ and the church."

He clears up the mystery. He is speaking about Christ and the church as covering and provider. You are bone of His bone and marrow of His marrow. He would no more let the church go with lack than you are supposed to let your family go with lack.

What does He want from us? Would it not be the fellowship of the one flesh? Do you not think He would like you to spend time with Him in worship and learn how to fellowship with Him out of your new nature? He is your provider.

Grace Cannot Be Earned by Works, Only Received From the Provider

Stand up. Did anybody have a good time?

He wants you. Quit wandering around in the desert.

Do you know how touchy God was when Israel came out and complained about provision? When He sent quail into the camp, they threw themselves on the birds, feathers flying, stripping flesh off the bones and gorging themselves because they were afraid for their provision. A lot of them died there.

He is touchy about that grace thing. You do some small thing and think you earned something, but you cannot earn what He has for you.

The man who picked up firewood on the Sabbath was the first to violate it. They did not know what to do with him. Firewood was a necessity. They put him in holding and asked Moses, and Moses asked God. God said, "Stone him."

For what? For picking up a necessity?

Under the shadow, what it meant was that salvation could be earned, and that was absolutely impossible. Death would be the result.

When I was in Israel with a group of missionaries from America, I was hard-pressed to find some who were not keeping some of the days: Sabbath, feast days, and things like that. One of them finally asked, "Why do you keep the Sabbath?"

Someone answered, "I feel more complete."

I could not take it anymore. I said, "If I never keep Saturday, which is the Sabbath, are you saying I will never be as complete as you are for keeping it?"

The issue was on, because I had sat there and listened to it for two days.

I said, "Do you want to know what the shadow of the Sabbath was? That day of rest He was talking about is the rest that remains for the people of God. If Joshua had given them rest, He would not have spoken afterward of another day. You were not created by good works. You were created unto good works. It is not by your works, lest any man should boast. It is the gift of God."

He looks at your needs that way too. It is not works in the same way, but it is about what you are trying to invoke blessing with. You cannot earn enough to save the world.

Hosea Kedachah.